

# FASTBREAK

High school hoops at a glance.

## Boys Top 25

1. St. Vincent-St. Mary (14-1): Idle. Next: Tomorrow vs. No. 14 Archbishop Hoban at Rhodes Arena.
2. Shaker Heights (11-3): Defeated Euclid, 54-47. Next: Tuesday vs. No. 9 Lakewood.
3. St. Edward (10-3): Lost to St. Ignatius, 76-71. Next: Tuesday vs. No. 13 St. Peter Chanel.
4. Warrensville Heights (15-1): Defeated Normandy, 66-50. Next: Tuesday vs. Parma.
5. Central-Hower (13-2): Defeated Akron East, 87-78. Next: Tuesday at Akron North.
6. Medina (13-2): Defeated Berea, 69-56. Next: Tuesday vs. Hudson.
7. Glenville (12-2): Defeated No. 18 Cleveland East, 64-62. Next: Today at Toledo Scott.
8. Cleveland Heights (8-6): Lost to No. 22 Mentor, 86-79. Next: Tuesday at No. 21 Elyria.
9. Lakewood (12-2): Defeated Valley Forge, 61-35. Next: Tuesday at No. 2 Shaker Heights.
10. Cleveland Central Catholic (12-3): Defeated Lake Catholic, 77-63. Next: Tuesday vs. Berea.
11. Elyria Catholic (13-2): Defeated Notre Dame-Cathedral Latin, 85-43. Next: Friday at Padua.
12. Brush (12-4): Defeated Nordonia, 58-49. Next: Friday vs. Kenston.
13. St. Peter Chanel (13-2): Defeated Holy Name, 64-53. Next: Tuesday at No. 3 St. Edward.
14. Archbishop Hoban (12-2): Idle. Next: Tomorrow vs. No. 1 St. Vincent-St. Mary.
15. Orange (10-3): Idle. Next: Today vs. Hawken at Lakeland C.C.
16. Benedictine (9-4): Idle. Next: Today at Walsh Jesuit.
17. Wadsworth (11-3): Lost to Tallmadge, 77-62. Next: Friday at Revere.
18. Cleveland East (11-5): Lost to No. 7 Glenville, 64-62. Next: Today at Geneva.
19. Barberton (13-2): Defeated Hudson, 55-53. Next: Friday vs. Stow.
20. Buchtel (11-5): Defeated Akron Garfield, 78-55. Next: Tuesday at Firestone.
21. Elyria (8-6): Idle. Next: Today vs. Southview.
22. Mentor (6-7): Defeated No. 8 Cleveland Heights, 86-79. Next: Tuesday at Valley Forge.
23. Brooklyn (11-1): Idle. Next: Today at Cuyahoga Heights.
24. Olmsted Falls (10-4): Defeated No. 25 North Olmsted, 64-50. Next: Today vs. Rocky River.
25. North Olmsted (10-5): Lost to No. 24 Olmsted Falls, 64-50. Next: Today vs. Fairview.

## Girls Top 25

1. Villa Angela-St. Joseph (15-1): Idle. Next: Today at Madison.
2. Regina (12-5): Idle. Next: Today at Canton Central Catholic.
3. East Tech (14-1): Defeated No. 25 John F. Kennedy, 68-29. Next: Tuesday vs. Collinwood at Senate Playoffs.
4. Elyria (15-0): Idle. Next: Today at Cleveland Heights.
5. Hudson (13-3): Idle. Next: Today vs. No. 14 Magnificat.
6. Wadsworth (15-1): Idle. Next: Today vs. Revere.
7. Walsh Jesuit (14-2): Idle. Next: Wednesday at Canton McKinley.
8. Archbishop Hoban (14-2): Idle. Next: Today vs. Cardinal Mooney.
9. Holy Name (14-2): Idle. Next: Today at St. Peter Chanel.
10. Copley (13-2): Idle. Next: Today at No. 22 Highland.
11. Shaw (14-3): Idle. Next: Today vs. Maple Heights.
12. Avon Lake (14-2): Idle. Next: Today vs. Amherst.
13. Eastlake North (11-7): Idle. Next: Today vs. Warren Harding.
14. Magnificat (11-5): Idle. Next: Today at No. 5 Hudson.
15. Padua (14-3): Idle. Next: Today vs. Trinity.
16. Barberton (11-6): Idle. Next: Tuesday vs. Stow.
17. Mentor (12-4): Idle. Next: Today vs. Valley Forge.
18. Bay (14-2): Idle. Next: Today vs. Westlake.
19. Warrensville Heights (14-4): Idle. Next: Today at Normandy.
20. Admiral King (12-7): Idle. Next: Wednesday at No. 12 Avon Lake.
21. Cuyahoga Falls (12-5): Idle. Next: Tuesday at Kent Roosevelt.
22. Highland (11-5): Idle. Next: Today vs. No. 10 Copley.
23. Vermilion (10-7): Idle. Next: Today at Lexington.
24. Keystone (16-1): Idle. Next: Today at Firelands.
25. John F. Kennedy (13-4): Lost to No. 3 East Tech, 68-29. Next: Tuesday vs. Glenville at Senate Playoffs.

## The James Journal

A weekly update on the life and times of LeBron James and the nationally ranked St. Vincent-St. Mary boys basketball team:

What's up: Sports Illustrated has had a writer and photographer in Akron this week to write about James and his teammates. The story could appear as early as editions that will hit newsstands Feb. 11. Also, the New York Daily News is working on a story. The Irish are ranked sixth in this week's USA Today Super 25.

What's ahead: Next up for SVSM is tomorrow's annual rivalry game with Archbishop Hoban, at 2 p.m. at Rhodes Arena. Then, it's a game the Irish have had circled on their calendar all season: the Feb. 10 rematch against USA Today's No. 1 team, Oak Hill Academy of Virginia, this year in Trenton, N.J. Oak Hill won last season's game in Columbus, 79-78, and eventually finished in the top spot in USA Today's poll.

## BOYS BASKETBALL

# Bulldogs' domination of Eagles continues

EDDIE DWYER  
Plain Dealer Reporter

#24 OLMSTED FALLS  
#25 NORTH OLMSTED

64  
50

North Olmsted coach Tim Schmotzer said it is probably as much psychological as it is physical.

Whatever the reason, Olmsted Falls definitely has the Eagles' number.

Olmsted Falls, behind a career-high 23 points by sophomore guard Dan Binggeli, turned back visiting North Olmsted, 64-50, last night in a key Southwestern Conference boys basketball game.

The Bulldogs, who have defeated the Eagles 15 consecutive times, improved to 10-4 and remained alone in first place in the SWC at 9-1. North Olmsted, which had won seven straight conference games before last night, slipped to 10-5,

"I really thought we had them on the ropes," said Schmotzer, whose team rallied from an 18-point deficit early in the second quarter and took a one-point lead with 1:09 remaining in the third quarter.

"We expended so much energy to get back in the game that it just seems to me that in the fourth quarter we kind of lost some poise. We got a little frustrated and we weren't focusing on the game like we should have, as far as how we needed to be playing. Plus fatigue was a factor.

"But, it all comes down to poise. That's how you win championships."

In a game in which the final score was

deceiving, Olmsted Falls rode its pressure defense and half-court offense to a 27-9 lead in the first half.

But North Olmsted, whose last victory over the Bulldogs came in January 1995, closed to 34-29 by halftime. The big baskets in the Eagles' run were a 3-pointer by senior forward Will Lytwyn and a three-point play by senior forward Scott Kovelan.

Controlling the defensive boards, North Olmsted took a 40-39 lead on Dave Janis' 3-pointer with 1:09 to go in the third quarter. However, in the final nine minutes, Olmsted Falls displayed the savvy that has helped it to six consecutive SWC championships.

After North Olmsted tied the score at 42 on a layup by senior forward Grant

Meczka, the Bulldogs responded with a 3-pointer from deep in the right corner by Binggeli. A layup by Binggeli off a steal and an assist by junior guard Tim Curran and a putback by sophomore forward Steve Gansey extended Olmsted Falls' lead to 49-42 with 5:03 left. The Bulldogs then benefited from clutch free-throw shooting by senior guard Neil Saluja and Binggeli.

"That game could have gone any direction," Olmsted Falls coach Pat Donahue said. "They had some bad breaks and some things go against them in that fourth quarter, and we were fortunate not to."

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## GIRLS BASKETBALL



ROADELL HICKMAN / THE PLAIN DEALER

East Tech's Lauren Billingsley watches the action after being tripped up during the Scarabs' 68-29 victory over John F. Kennedy yesterday afternoon.

# Delay no big deal Scarabs take a while to warm up, romp past Eagles

BOB FORTUNA  
Plain Dealer Reporter

#3 EAST TECH  
#25 JOHN F. KENNEDY

68  
29

Not even a 45-minute delay at the start of the game at John F. Kennedy could keep East Tech down for too long yesterday afternoon.

Once they started feeling their oats, the Scarabs cruised to a 68-29 victory to give them their seventh consecutive Senate Athletic League regular-season championship.

The game, delayed because only one official showed up on time, was close for a half. Tech held a slim 11-9 lead after the first quarter, but extended that advantage to 25-14 by intermission before busting loose in the third quarter.

Is Tech 39 points better than JFK?

"Today, yes," said Eagles coach Leonard Patterson, whose team was beaten by the Scarabs, 63-32, earlier this season. "This time, we played with them for a half."

The third quarter was disastrous for

JFK (13-4, 9-2). The Eagles made 2 of 13 shots from the field and both of their foul shots but still trailed, 44-20, heading into the fourth quarter.

The Scarabs, ranked No. 2 statewide in Division II, made good on 7 of 17 tries from the field and 6 of 9 from the foul line.

"I don't think that delay affected us," Scarabs coach William Stovall said. "Playing on the road, I talked to the girls about playing at our tempo and not allowing the crowd to influence us."

"We were pressing for shots when the game was close, but once we settled down, the whole mode of the game changed."

Tech (14-1, 11-0) scored 11 straight points midway through the third quarter.

Barbara Turner led the surge, scoring seven of her 21 points during the stretch, and finished with 15 rebounds and five blocks.

Lauren Billingsley had 21 points and

four rebounds, and Tiera Allen had 15 points and six rebounds. Sophomore guard Britney Walker led the Eagles with 11 points.

"We came out a little lax, then we got into our groove and pulled it out," Allen said. "We weren't taking our time and doing what we're supposed to do at the beginning of the game."

"We were a little impatient and a little erratic, but it was just a matter of time. Barbara [Turner] played an excellent game. She rebounded like I don't know what. We got incredible offense from her and Lauren [Billingsley], and it was just an outstanding effort from everyone."

JFK might have another shot at the Scarabs, but they'll need to beat Glenville in Tuesday's playoffs. Tech plays Collinwood in the other game, with the semifinal winners meeting for the overall title Friday at 6 p.m. at Cleveland South.

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# Perry races past weakened Hawken

MIKE PETICCA  
Plain Dealer Reporter

PERRY  
HAWKEN

59  
33

It seemed that last night's girls basketball game between Hawken and host Perry would be an intriguing matchup.

Both teams had one defeat. Both teams were 8-0 in their Chagrin Valley Conference races and had clinched shares of division titles: Hawken in the Valley Division, Perry in the Chagrin.

But standout Hawken forward Mary Vargo sprained an ankle. Then, Hawks forward Carmen Rowan, averaging 16 points and 11 rebounds, got the flu. With Vargo sidelined for the game and Rowan unable to start, Perry took advantage, racing to a 24-2 lead.

"We totally respect them as a team," Perry coach Dan D'Amore said of Hawken after his Pirates coasted to a 58-33 victory. "They have some nice players, and they play well together. They were banged up a little, and there was some sickness, but

we'll take it."

Guard Amanda Tsipis scored 21 points for Perry and point guard Nikki Altenweg had 17 points, 11 steals, eight assists and seven rebounds as the Pirates improved to 16-1. Rowan came off the bench midway in the first quarter, and although obviously slowed, totaled nine points and nine rebounds. Hawken is 13-2.

"We didn't come ready to play," Hawks coach Lori Morth said. "We're not healthy. Perry came ready to play and was aggressive all over the court."

Tsipis and Altenweg combined to score Perry's first 22 points — each player getting 11 of them. Tsipis opened the game by converting two fast-break layups, and Altenweg followed with an outside shot and a driving layup. Each player canned a 3-point shot during the flurry.

Tsipis, a 5-9 sophomore, finished 7-of-9

from the field. Altenweg, a 5-7 senior, is averaging 19.5 points, 7.9 steals, 6.9 rebounds and 6.8 assists.

"We didn't come out for some games with the intensity that we should have," Altenweg said. "We focused a lot on that. And then we wanted to keep that up because we didn't want to let them back in the game."

The closest Hawken got the rest of the way was 28-13 at halftime. Jeanne Myers finished with nine points and six rebounds for Perry. Hawken's Sarah Wilson had eight points and six rebounds, and Amelia Gaudio grabbed 14 rebounds.

Perry hopes to be voted tomorrow as the first seed for the Division II sectional-district tournament at Ashtabula Edgewood. Hawken hopes to be second to Villa Angela-St. Joseph in the Pymatuning Valley Division III seeding.

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## ROUNDUP

# Healthy Wildcats triumph

From staff reports

Watch out. St. Ignatius' basketball team is starting to get healthy again.

The Wildcats handled the pressure of visiting St. Edward last night and scored a 76-71 win in a boys nonconference basketball game.

A series of injuries had left the defending Division I state champions struggling and with a 7-7 record. Included among the hurt were Ryan Stilphen, who was injured in the Jan. 12 loss to St. Edward and returned to action last night; and Terry Walsh, who last night made his first start since injuring an ankle Dec. 20 against Mentor.

Both contributed as the Wildcats knocked off The Plain Dealer's third-ranked team and gave coach Brian Becker reason for optimism.

"I do think there's better basketball ahead for us," Becker said. "Those injuries will help us, because I was forced to play other kids who might not have played."

Mike McGlynn scored 25 to lead St. Ignatius. Greg Moviel scored 17 and Walsh had 16. Samario Clancy scored 21 points to lead the Eagles (10-2).

**Kenston 103, Mayfield 94** The Bombers held on to win a three-overtime game that saw buzzer-beating 3-pointers at the end of regulation, the first overtime and the second overtime.

Kenston (12-4, 6-2 Western Reserve Conference North) got 26 points from Matt Phillips, 22 from Bob Dubovec and 21 from Joe Motley. Dubovec hit the 3-pointer at the end of the first OT.

**Glenville 64, East 62** Troy Smith hit four free throws in the last 30 seconds to seal the Senate win for the Tarblooders. Esceck Bryant and James Griffin led Glenville with 23 and 18 points, respectively. Nick McCrimmon and DeAuntay Scott had 19 and 12, respectively, for East. The Blue Bombers (11-5, 8-3) are ranked 18th by The Plain Dealer. Glenville (12-3, 9-2) is seventh.

**Mentor 86, Cleveland Hts. 79** Junior guard Eddie Zienkowski had 31 points, four assists and two rebounds as the Cardinals upset The Plain Dealer's eighth-ranked team on its home court in an LEL Lake Division game.

**Shaker Hts. 54, Euclid 47** The Raiders put in a workmanlike effort in a home win that kept their Lake Erie Lake Division record perfect. Darrell White (13 points) and Anthony Teague (12) led the way for Shaker. The Raiders (11-3, 8-0) are ranked second by The Plain Dealer. Michael Holloway scored 18 of his 20 points in the second half for the Panthers (7-8, 3-5).

**St. Peter Chanel 64, Holy Name 53** The Firebirds outscored the Green Wave, 23-7, in the fourth quarter to secure a North Coast League win in Bedford. Five players scored in double figures for Chanel (14-3, 10-2). Rob Jordan led The Plain Dealer's 10th-ranked team with 17 points.

**Central Catholic 77, Lake Catholic 63** Michael Melton had a 24-point night as the Ironmen notched an NCL road victory. Central Catholic, ranked 10th by The Plain Dealer, also received 22 points from Michael Duncan. The Ironmen are 12-3, 10-1 in the NCL.